

Man in the Box -- Alice In Chains

From *Facelift* (1990). About 108 BPM, est. Eb tuning, matching the guitar. On the 5-string, stay in standard and read the riff down a half step.

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. GP-5 only.

Thick, gritty, and heavy. The bass doubles the grinding riff and fills out the sludge underneath the guitar.

Built from the song's overall sound. I haven't verified the exact bass rig on the record.

A pick for the grind. Both pickups up. Tone knob around 60%.

AMP: Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT) + CAB: Sunn215 IR (User IR 8)

A driven SVT into Sunn215. The IR notes call the Sunn 2x15 fat and great with distortion. That's exactly a sludge-rock bass cab.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 25.

The gain is up. 25 keeps the stops tight.

PRE -- COMP (Ross), always on.

Sustain: 40, VOL: 58.

Evens the picked grind.

DST -- Bass OD, always on.

Gain: 50, Blend: 45, VOL: 55, Bass: 55, Treble: 50.

Always-on grit is part of the core tone here. Blend 45 keeps the fundamental.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on.

Gain: 45, Bass: 58, Middle: 58, MidFreq: 450Hz, Treble: 48, VOL: 62.

SVT hair at gain 45. The mid push helps the bass grind with the guitar.

CAB -- User IR 8 (Sunn215), always on.

VOL: 60.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, on CTL.

50Hz: +1, 120Hz: +1, 400Hz: +2, 800Hz: +3, 4.5kHz: 0, VOL: 56.

On CTL. It adds a 400Hz and 800Hz growl plus level for the choruses and the solo, so the bass cuts through the densest parts.

MOD -- off.

DLY -- off.

RVB -- off. Dry and heavy.

CTL footswitch

On CTL: EQ (Bass EQ 2, growl boost).

- **CTL off** -- Riff and verses. Thick, gritty, heavy. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- Choruses and the solo. Extra midrange growl and level to cut through the wall.

Engage at the choruses and under the solo.